

Medical marvels

The men who made MEDICINE modern

Not so long ago you were as likely to die from the treatment your doctor gave you as you were from the disease itself. These medical pioneers changed all that.

Did you know?

In Greece, Hippocrates (460–370 BCE) was the first person to say that diseases were not caused by evil spirits!



Edward Jenner (1749–1823)

In the 18th century, **smallpox**—a contagious disease that causes a serious rash—was **England's biggest killer**. Jenner had the idea that if people were given a weak dose of smallpox, their body would be prepared to fight off a stronger infection. Jenner had invented a smallpox **VACCINATION**, which has been saving lives ever since.



Bacteria are still the world's biggest killer →

Louis Pasteur (1822–1895)

People used to think that **bacteria** were far too small to harm a human being. Pasteur was a French chemist who proved that—despite their tiny size—bacteria actually cause lots of **nasty diseases**, such as cholera. He also showed that you could kill bacteria by boiling them—a method we call **PASTEURIZATION**.

The hypodermic syringe was invented in 1853 as a way of delivering drugs beneath the skin.

